

★ = high chance of appearing (ranked against past IBPS PO Mains papers and 2026 bank exams). Each answer is followed by the key fact and its source. Marking: +1.2 right, -0.30 wrong.

1. As per RBI's directions on counterfeit notes, a bank branch must file an FIR with the police immediately when the number of counterfeit notes detected in a single transaction is at least: ★

Ans (D) 5 pieces

RBI Master Direction on Counterfeit Notes (1 Apr 2026): an FIR for 5 or more pieces in one transaction; up to 4 pieces go in a consolidated monthly report to the police. Notes are stamped 'COUNTERFEIT BANKNOTE IMPOUNDED' and are never returned to the tenderer.

2. Bank branches must exchange soiled notes over the counter, free of charge, when a person tenders up to: ★

Ans (C) 20 pieces with a maximum value of Rs 5,000 per day

RBI Master Direction on Facility for Exchange of Notes and Coins (1 Apr 2026): up to 20 pieces worth at most Rs 5,000 a day are exchanged free. Larger lots are accepted against a receipt and credited within 7 days.

3. Which of the following is NOT one of the seven 'Sutras' in RBI's FREE-AI framework for the financial sector (August 2025)?

Ans (B) Regulation before Innovation

FREE-AI report (13 Aug 2025; committee chaired by Dr Pushpak Bhattacharyya). The 7 sutras are Trust is the Foundation, People First, Innovation over Restraint, Fairness & Equity, Accountability, Understandable by Design, and Safety, Resilience & Sustainability.

4. Under RBI's medium-term strategy framework 'Utkarsh 2029', released in April 2026, the initiative 'Sa-Mudra' is aimed at:

Ans (D) Modernising currency management by digitising manual processes

RBI released Utkarsh 2029 on 10 Apr 2026. Under it, Project Sa-Mudra modernises currency management systems (BusinessLine, Apr 2026).

5. RBI's 'Mission SAKSHAM', launched in April 2026 to train about 1.40 lakh participants, is a capacity-building initiative for:

Ans (A) Urban Co-operative Banks

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra launched Mission SAKSHAM on 28 Apr 2026. It will train about 1.40 lakh board members, managers and staff of Urban Co-operative Banks (GKToday / Business Standard, Apr 2026).

6. 'Pension Sahayak' is an AI-enabled grievance redressal platform launched in June 2026 that lets subscribers lodge complaints by voice and WhatsApp. Which body launched it?

Ans (B) Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA)

PFRDA launched the 'PFRDA Pension Sahayak' portal for NPS and pension grievances on 22 Jun 2026 (ET / Moneycontrol, Jun 2026).

7. The Rs 33,660 crore BHAVYA scheme of DPIIT, which aims to develop 100 plug-and-play industrial parks, stands for: ★

Ans (D) Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojana

BHAVYA stands for Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojana, a Rs 33,660 crore DPIIT scheme for 100 industrial parks. Piyush Goyal launched the BHAVYA portal in June 2026 (PIB / DD India, Jun 2026).

8. How many characters make up the Unique Transaction Reference (UTR) number of an RTGS transaction? ★

Ans (B) 22

An RTGS UTR has 22 characters and a NEFT UTR has 16. RTGS has a minimum of Rs 2 lakh and no upper limit.

9. Which entity operates the Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS)? ★

Ans (B) NPCI Bharat BillPay Ltd (NBBL)

BBPS is run by NBBL, a wholly owned NPCI subsidiary. RBI itself operates RTGS and NEFT.

10. Under the Lead Bank Scheme, which forum operates at the block level to coordinate credit delivery?

Ans (B) BLBC

The Lead Bank Scheme has the SLBC at state level, the DCC and DLRC at district level, and the Block Level Bankers' Committee (BLBC) at block level.

11. Under the PML Rules, the aggregate of all credits in a 'small account' in a financial year must not exceed:

Ans (A) Rs 1 lakh

Small account limits: credits up to Rs 1 lakh a year, withdrawals up to Rs 10,000 a month, and a balance of at most Rs 50,000 at any time.

12. The Income-tax Act, 2025 came into force on 1 April 2026 and uses a single 'tax year' concept. Which form has Form 130 replaced?

Ans (D) Form 16

Under the Income-tax Act 2025 and Rules 2026 (from 1 Apr 2026), Form 130 replaces Form 16 (the salary TDS certificate) and Form 168 replaces Form 26AS (ET, Feb 2026).

13. On which date is the India-New Zealand Free Trade Agreement scheduled to come into force? ★

Ans (B) 20 October 2026

Piyush Goyal announced on 21 Sep 2026, after ratification, that the FTA takes effect on 20 Oct 2026, giving 100% of Indian exports duty-free access (Reuters / The Hindu, Sep 2026).

14. The India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) entered into force on:

Ans (C) 1 June 2026

The CEPA was signed in Muscat on 18 Dec 2025 and came into force on 1 Jun 2026, giving about 99% of Indian exports duty-free access (ET / The Hindu, Jun 2026).

15. What was RBI's Financial Inclusion Index (FI-Index) for March 2026, and which of its three parameters carries the highest weight? ★

Ans (C) 70.0; Usage

The FI-Index rose 4.48% to 70.0 in Mar 2026 from 67.0 (RBI, 16 Jul 2026). Weights are Access 35%, Usage 45% and Quality 20%.

16. Sarnath was inscribed as India's 45th UNESCO World Heritage Site on 25 July 2026 at the 48th session of the World Heritage Committee. Where was that session held? ★

Ans (B) Busan, South Korea

The 48th WHC session was held in Busan in Jul 2026. The 'Ancient Buddhist Site of Sarnath' was inscribed on 25 Jul 2026 as India's 45th site (PIB / UNESCO, Jul 2026).

17. Glaw Lake, designated India's 101st Ramsar site on 3 August 2026, became the first Ramsar wetland of which state? ★

Ans (A) Arunachal Pradesh

Glaw Lake is in Lohit district of Arunachal Pradesh, inside Kamlang Tiger Reserve. Its designation made it the state's first Ramsar site and India's 101st (DD News, 3 Aug 2026).

18. Which refining CPSE, a subsidiary of Indian Oil Corporation, was granted Navratna status in June 2026, becoming India's 28th Navratna? ★

Ans (D) Chennai Petroleum Corporation Ltd

CPCL became the 28th Navratna CPSE on 19 Jun 2026. GRSE also received Navratna status in June 2026 (ET / Upstox, Jun 2026).

19. What is the reference date for Census 2027, India's first digital census, in most of the country (excluding snow-bound areas)?

Ans (A) 1 March 2027

The reference date is 00:00 hrs on 1 Mar 2027, and 1 Oct 2026 for snow-bound areas (MHA notification, Jun 2025). Census 2027 also includes caste enumeration.